

Timothy L. Jones

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Duke University, Program in American Grand Strategy <i>America in the World Consortium Postdoctoral Fellow</i> Durham, NC	September 2025–present
Naval Postgraduate School, Department of Defense Analysis <i>Faculty Associate – Research AD-01</i> Monterey, CA	April 2025–present
Naval Postgraduate School, Department of Defense Analysis <i>Donald R. Beall Postdoctoral Defense Fellow</i> Monterey, CA	August 2023–March 2025

EDUCATION

University of Michigan <i>Ph.D., Political Science</i> Ann Arbor, MI	2023
University of California, San Diego <i>M.I.A., International Politics</i> San Diego, CA	2017
National Intelligence University <i>M.S., Strategic Intelligence</i> Washington, DC	2011
American Military University <i>B.A., International Relations</i> Charles Town, WV	2010
Indiana University <i>B.A., Political Science</i> Bloomington, IN	2005

DISSERTATION

Unraveling Rebel Strategies: Exploring Patterns of Violence in Civil War
Committee: James Morrow (chair), Christopher Fariss, Kevin Quinn, Yuri Zhukov.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

International security; civil war; insurgency; terrorism; intelligence; special operations; irregular warfare; causal inference; spatial statistics; machine learning.
Regional expertise: Middle East, Central Asia, East Africa.

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

“Adapting Under Pressure: Diversification of Rebel Violence in Civil Wars.” *Civil Wars*. Forthcoming.

“Frogmen and Fast Boats: The Future of Irregular Warfare in the Maritime Domain.” with John Willingham and Kenneth Walls. *Inter Populum Journal of Irregular Warfare and Special Operations* 3(2), 2025, 72–98.

“Meta-Analysis and the Integration of Terrorism Event Databases.” *International Journal of Cyber Warfare and Terrorism* 13(1), 2023, 1–20.

Book Project

Special Intelligence: Organizations, Secrecy, and the Politics of Limited Force. In preparation.

Editor-Reviewed Articles

“Peace Agreements and the Persuasive Authority of International Law.” *Minnesota Journal of International Law* 34(1), 2025, 1–86.

Working Papers

“Sequenced Legibility: Territorial Control, Development Aid, and Wartime Order” with Daniel Karell, Yale University. *Under review*.

“Taking Out the Competition: Lessons from Algeria on Rebel Targeting of Nonviolent Resistance Campaigns.” with Martin Macias-Medellin, University of Michigan.

“Kidnapping and the Consolidation of Rebel Rule: Evidence from Iraq and Syria, 2014–2016” with Ilayda Onder, Texas A&M University and Mark Berlin, American University.

“Signaling in the Dark: The Opacity Dilemma and the SOF–Cyber–Space Triad”

“From Rebel Governance to State Legibility: Wartime Ties and Postwar Rule” with Shelley Liu, Duke University.

Public Writing

“What the Candidates Can Learn from Two Former Presidents about Foreign Policy.” with David Dezso. *The Hill*, January 2024.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Intelligence Support to Special Operations (*graduate level*) Spring 2025
Instructor of Record.

Intelligence, Surprise, and Special Operations: Methods for Identifying Uncertainty and Forecasting the Future (*graduate level*) Fall 2024
Instructor of Record.

The Use of Social Science Computer Programs (*graduate level*) Fall 2022
Instructor of Record.

How to Be an Autocrat (*undergraduate level*) Fall 2021
Graduate Student Instructor. Course head: Mai Hassan.

Introduction to World Politics (*undergraduate level*) Fall 2018; Fall 2020
Graduate Student Instructor. Course head: James Morrow.

Modern Warfare (*undergraduate level*) Fall 2019
Graduate Student Instructor. Course head: Yuri Zhukov.

Economics, Politics, and International Change (*undergraduate level*)
Graduate Student Instructor. Course head: Stephen Haggard.

Fall 2016

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student Research Assistant, Christopher Fariss, 2022.

Graduate Student Research Assistant, Yuri Zhukov, 2019.

Graduate Student Research Assistant, Mai Hassan, 2018.

[Policy Design and Evaluation Lab](#), Research Assistant for Craig McIntosh and Jennifer Burney, 2016–2017.

GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND AWARDS

Multi-Method Conflict Consortium Junior Fellowship, 2026

Donald R. Beall Defense Fellow Research Grant, \$8,000.

Political Science Research Grant, University of Michigan, 2023, \$1,600.

American Political Science Association Conference Travel Grant, 2022, \$150.

Davis Fellows for Peace, Middlebury Institute of International Studies, \$9,600.

Foreign Language and Area Studies Fellowship, University of Michigan, \$5,500.

Hewlett Foundation Merit Fellowship, University of California, \$48,000.

Robinson Summer Graduate Research Fellowship, University of California, \$5,000.

Friends of the International Center Award, University of California, \$1,500.

Education Abroad Summer Study Award, University of California, \$1,000.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Multi-Method Conflict Consortium (M2C2), Duke University, 2026.

Peace Science Society (International) Annual Meeting, 2023, 2026.

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, 2022-2026.

International Studies Association Annual Convention, 2023-2026.

America in the World Young Scholars Conference, University of Texas-Austin, 2026

American Branch of the International Law Association, International Law Weekend, 2022.

Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting, 2022.

PROFESSIONAL AND GOVERNMENT EXPERIENCE

Naval Special Warfare Development Group (DEVGRU)

August 2012–April 2015

Senior Targeting Officer, GG-0132-13-10

Tactical Development and Evaluation Squadron One.

Defense Intelligence Agency

April 2008–August 2012

Senior Intelligence Analyst, GG-0132-14-03

Joint Intelligence Task Force Combating Terrorism.

Defense Intelligence Agency

November 2001–November 2002; February 2005–April 2008

Senior NCO All-Source Analyst, SFC/35F30

U.S. Army Reserves
Senior NCO All-Source Analyst, SFC/35F30

November 1999–November 2011

JOINT-DUTY ASSIGNMENTS AND DEPLOYMENTS

Central Intelligence Agency Counterproliferation Center <i>Liaison Officer</i>	2014–2015
Special Operations Task Force – Afghanistan <i>J2 – Director of Intelligence</i>	2013–2014
Special Operations Task Force – East Africa <i>Senior Intelligence Analyst</i>	2011
Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff – J2 <i>Subject Matter Expert Briefer – Terrorism</i>	2009–2010
Inter-Agency Intelligence Task Force – Arabian Peninsula <i>Embassy Targeting Officer</i>	2009
Special Operations Task Force – Iraq <i>Senior Intelligence Analyst</i>	2008
Special Operations Task Force – Iraq <i>Intelligence Analyst</i>	2007
Special Operations Task Force – Iraq <i>Intelligence, Surveillance, and Reconnaissance Analyst</i>	2005

SERVICE

Conflict & Peace, Research & Development Workshop, University of Michigan
Participant, 2017–present; Coordinator, 2021–2023.

Combating Threats Exchange
Editorial Review Board.

International Studies Quarterly; Combating Threats Exchange
Peer reviewer.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

American Political Science Association; Peace Science Society–International; Midwest Political Science Association.

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Technical: R; Python; GIS, including ESRI ArcGIS Suite, Google Earth Engine, and R; Stata; L^AT_EX.

Languages: German, intermediate; Persian, intermediate; Mandarin Chinese, basic; Arabic, Modern Standard, basic.

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

Analytic and briefing training: Writing for the Presidential Daily Brief; Advanced Defense Intelligence Writing; Advanced Defense Intelligence Briefing; Critical Thinking Structured Analysis; Joint Intelligence Task Force–Combating Terrorism 101.

Technical and geospatial training: Fundamentals of Deep Learning; Introduction to ArcGIS I & II; Proton; IC Reach; Palantir; Analyst Notebook; HUMINT Online Tasking and Reporting Consumer Course; Basic Geospatial Metadata Analysis Course.

Operational and leadership training: Survival, Evasion, Resistance, and Escape 215 and 245; High-Threat Environment Travelers Course; Collection Management for Analysts Course; Advanced Non-Commissioned Officer Course; Basic Non-Commissioned Officer Course; Primary Leadership Development Course.